

```

Command Line
File Edit Tabs Help
sn@sn-toshiba:~$ history 5
 19  who
 20  ps
 21  free
 22  clear
 23  history 5
sn@sn-toshiba:~$ history -c
sn@sn-toshiba:~$ history
 1  history
sn@sn-toshiba:~$

```

Figure 2: The *history* command with the *-c* option

with spaces before them will not be logged.

```
$HISTCONTROL=ignorespace
```

You can also completely delete all the commands of the current session from the *History* file by giving the following command:

```
$history -c
```

The command given below will wipe out the commands completely.

```
$history -cw
```

One way of stopping the saving of commands for the current session, but not erasing the previous commands already saved in the *History* file, is to stop the recording of the commands by disabling history.

```
$set -o history
```

The above command will stop logging the commands until you log out from the session.

A specific command can be deleted from the *History* file by giving the number of the command and the *-d* switch with the *History* command. The following command will delete the 50th command in the history:

```
$history -d 50
```

The *shred* command

When a file is deleted from the disk, the contents of the file are not actually deleted and can be retrieved with the right set of tools. The *shred* utility, available in most versions of Linux, can be used to completely overwrite a file to wipe its original contents.

```
$shred trial.txt
```

The above command will overwrite contents of the file *trial.txt*.



Figure 3: The output when a text file is displayed after being shredded

The contents are overwritten three times, by default. This number can be changed with the *-n* option.

```
$shred -n1 trial.txt
```

The file can also be deleted after being overwritten with the *-u* option.

```
$shred -u trial.txt
```

The *-z* option does the final overwrite with zeros. More options can be found using the *man* command.

The *shred* command may not work effectively in the modern log-structured or journaled file systems like Ext3, ReiserFS, JFS, etc, due to different ways of storing the file.

Encryption in Vi editor

You can also encrypt a file in the Vi/Vim editor. To encrypt a file, go to the command mode and type the following command:

```
:X
```

You will then be asked to enter the password twice, after which the file will be saved in the encrypted format. The editor will ask for the password when you want to open the file the next time onwards.

The file can be decrypted by opening it in the Vi/Vim editor and typing the following in the command mode:

```
:X
```

The editor will ask for the password, after which you can press the *Enter* key twice and exit the editor by typing *:wq* in the command mode. The file will then be saved in the decrypted form.

Encrypting a file in the CLI

When it is required to password protect confidential files